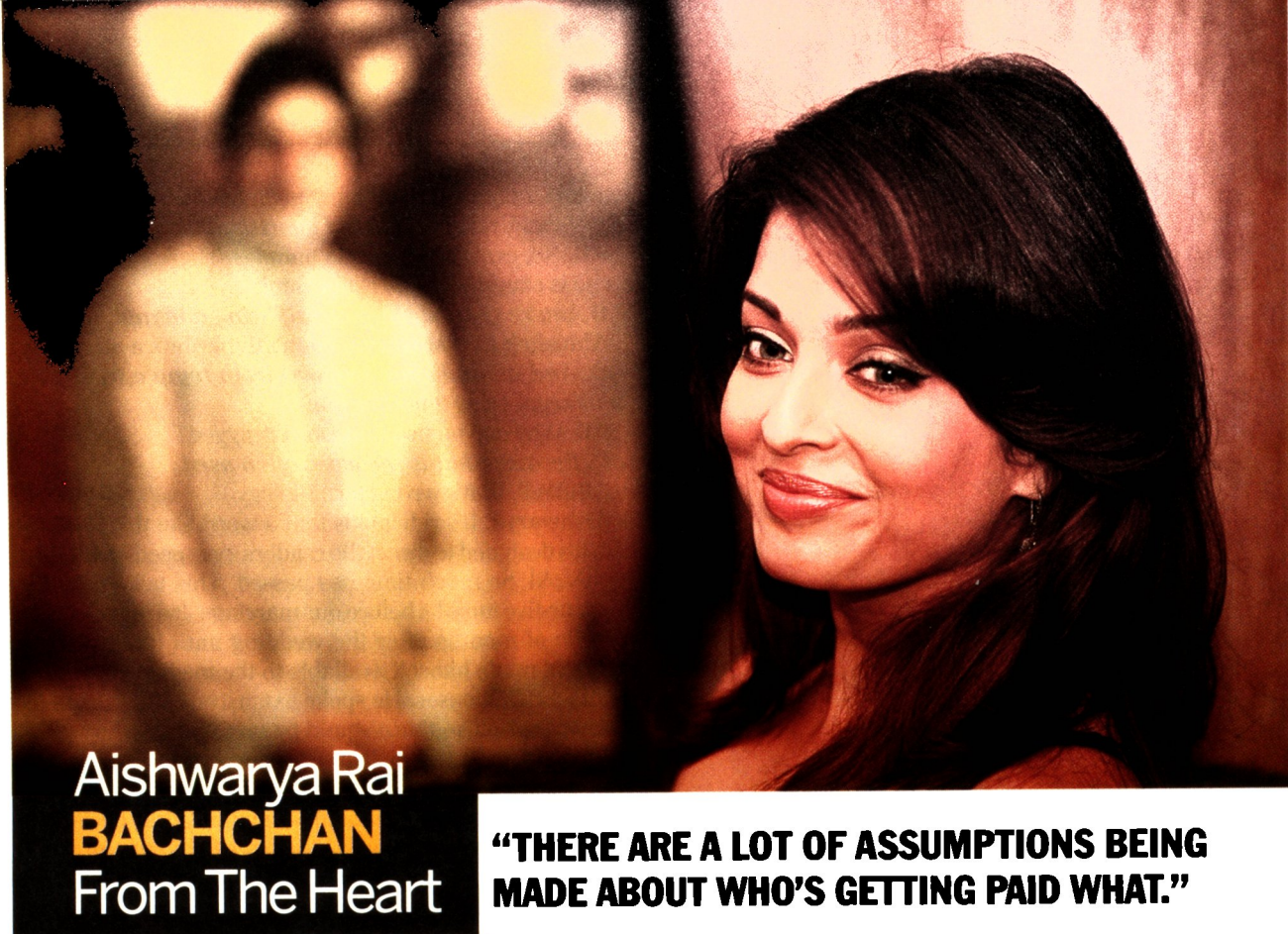




Aishwarya Rai
BACHCHAN
From The Heart

"THERE ARE A LOT OF ASSUMPTIONS BEING MADE ABOUT WHO'S GETTING PAID WHAT."



"Abhishek is so malleable and open to the craft of acting. I respect that and relate to the work he chooses to do."

"I'm so at home in my so-called new home. It's just as if I moved from Bandra to Juhu."

"Pa really enjoys writing his blog. We have fun."

from the US. Now, I can't go around explaining that to everybody because sometimes they just don't want to listen. So either you just keep quiet and don't let it bother you or you try clarifying it. I chose to keep quiet because I thought once the movie is released, it will speak for itself.

Q. But what is your reaction when you see your father being attacked, for instance, by Raj Thackeray, though he's just one of the many outsiders, so to speak, in Bollywood? And you were born and bred in Mumbai?

AB Jr. I wasn't here when this incident took place. Dad told me about it a day or two after it happened. He told me what he'd done. He'd taken the lawful route, reported it to the police and let the law of the land take its course. There's nothing else you can do. You've done what you should be doing as citizens of the country. We can't take the law into our own hands unless it's in front of the camera.

Q. But it must have been a shock to you, Mr Bachchan?

AB. No attack surprises me anymore. Something new happens every second day. It just comes with the territory.

Q. For so long you've been exemplified as the man who

kept a dignified silence. Why hit back now?

AB. If there is a callous remark, if there is disinformation, if there is sarcasm, if there is unwanted questioning, would you call it hitting back? I'm just making my point.

Q. Why did you need to clarify to several media houses?

AB. There were very severe accusations which were religious in nature, questioned the integrity of my father, his thoughts and his philosophy. I find it extremely humiliating that they wrote about a person who is not there to defend himself. So as his son, I defend him. Tomorrow when I'm not around, I would expect Abhishek to do so. That's the tradition with which I've been brought up. Is it all right for the media to give their opinion, which is their right and they must, and criticise and avoid someone who wants to do the same? Most of you are not getting the intent right. I'm not against journalists. I'm not against the media. We exist because of the media. But your freedom cannot entirely be yours. Along with your freedom, is our freedom as well. Along with that is vigilance. Both, you and me, need to be on a plane where there is healthy discourse. You're docu-